

Day 8 — Project Session 1: Plan

Module: Doṣas · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students have a one-page plan for their *5-day doṣa-aware week* project, with a chosen target *doṣa* tendency, three concrete daily changes, and the citation they will use.

Materials

- Project brief printed (one per student) — see `assessments/project-brief.md`
- Rubric printed (one per student) — see `assessments/rubric.md`
- Lined paper for the plan
- Coloured pens

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Read aloud the project brief, top half. Take 2 student questions.
- “*By the end of today, every one of you walks out with a written plan paragraph + a list of three changes.*”

Core (5 min)

1. **The structure of the project — recap:**
 - Pick ONE *doṣa* tendency you’ve noticed in yourself (from Day 3 worksheet — privately).
 - Design 5 days of small, realistic changes that would *support balance* for that *doṣa*.
 - Show: (a) what each change is, (b) which *doṣa* concept it relates to, (c) one citation from `sources.md`.
 - Present in 3 minutes on Day 10.
2. **Realistic, not heroic.** “*Don’t write ‘5 am wake’ if you currently wake at 7 am. The point is honest small adjustment — not transformation.*”
3. **Show the rubric.** Walk through quickly. Highlight the “Use of sources” criterion — they must cite Caraka or Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya by reference. Paraphrase OK.

Activity (30 min) — Plan writing

Students work individually (or in pairs if their target *doṣa* is the same).

The plan template (write on the board for students to copy onto their plan page):

1. My target tendency (e.g. "I notice some Vāta excess in winter – dry skin, light sleep"):

2. Three qualities I'll lean toward to balance:
(e.g. for vāta: warm, oily, grounding)

- _____
- _____
- _____

3. Five days of small changes – ONE per day:

Day 1: _____
Day 2: _____
Day 3: _____
Day 4: _____
Day 5: _____

4. For each change, the underlying doṣa concept:

Day 1 concept: _____
Day 2 concept: _____
Day 3 concept: _____
Day 4 concept: _____
Day 5 concept: _____

5. Citation I'll use:

(e.g. "Aṣṭāṅga Hṛdaya, Sūtrasthāna 1.6–7 – the doṣa-dhātu-māla framework")

6. My presentation format:

☐ Poster (A2)
☐ Live demo (2 min)
☐ Short story (1 page)
☐ 90-sec video
☐ Infographic
☐ Original song / poem
☐ Other (teacher-approved): _____

7. One thing I will NOT do (because it would be unsafe or unrealistic):

Teacher walks around. Quick interventions: - Students writing extreme plans ("fast for 5 days") — redirect to small + realistic. - Students with no plan — sit with them, walk through one example. - Students who finish quickly — sketch the visual layout of their poster.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Each student reads aloud their **Day 1** change to a partner. Partner gives one piece of feedback.
- Photograph or scan each plan before they leave. (Submitted as “draft 1.”)
- Preview Day 9: “*Tomorrow — refine and start building the actual artefact.*”

Student-facing content

The project, in one paragraph:

Design a 5-day doṣa-aware week for yourself. Pick ONE doṣa tendency from your self-observation. Plan 5 small, realistic daily changes that would support balance for that doṣa. Explain each change with the underlying concept. Cite one classical source. Present in 3 minutes on Day 10.

The principle behind the project:

The doṣa framework is most useful when it changes what you *do* — even a little. Designing a plan is the test of whether you’ve understood it.

Homework

- Refine your plan. Sleep on it. Cross out anything that won’t fit your actual week. Bring two extra ideas tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** Add a Day 6 — a “what I’ll change if Day 5 doesn’t work” contingency. Forces metacognition.
- **One tier down:** Stick to ONE change repeated daily. Five repetitions of the same change.

Teacher notes

- Reject plans involving medication, fasting beyond skipping one snack, intense exercise programmes, or anything that touches existing care.
- Some students will copy their friend’s plan. Each plan must be *theirs* (anchored to their own self-observation). Pair-work is fine if both partners agree on the target *doṣa*.
- The “one thing I will NOT do” prompt is important — it forces the safety lens.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No new citations today. Students choose from `sources.md`.